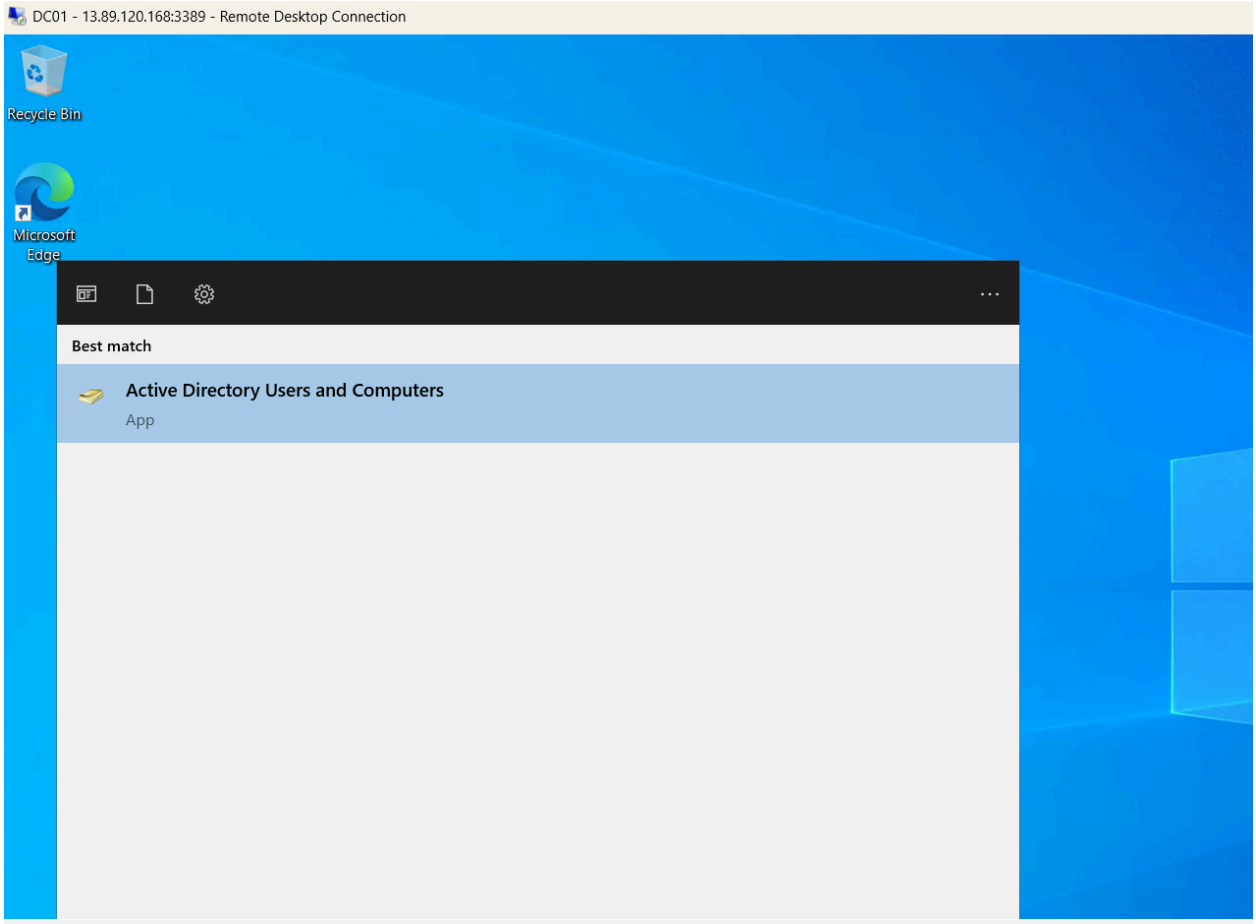
Step 4 — Create Organizational Units

In this step, I will create a realistic Organizational Unit (OU) structure based on branch location. This mirrors how Active Directory is commonly structured in production environments, especially in banks and multi-site organizations.
Location-based OUs make it easier to apply Group Policy, troubleshoot issues, and delegate access.

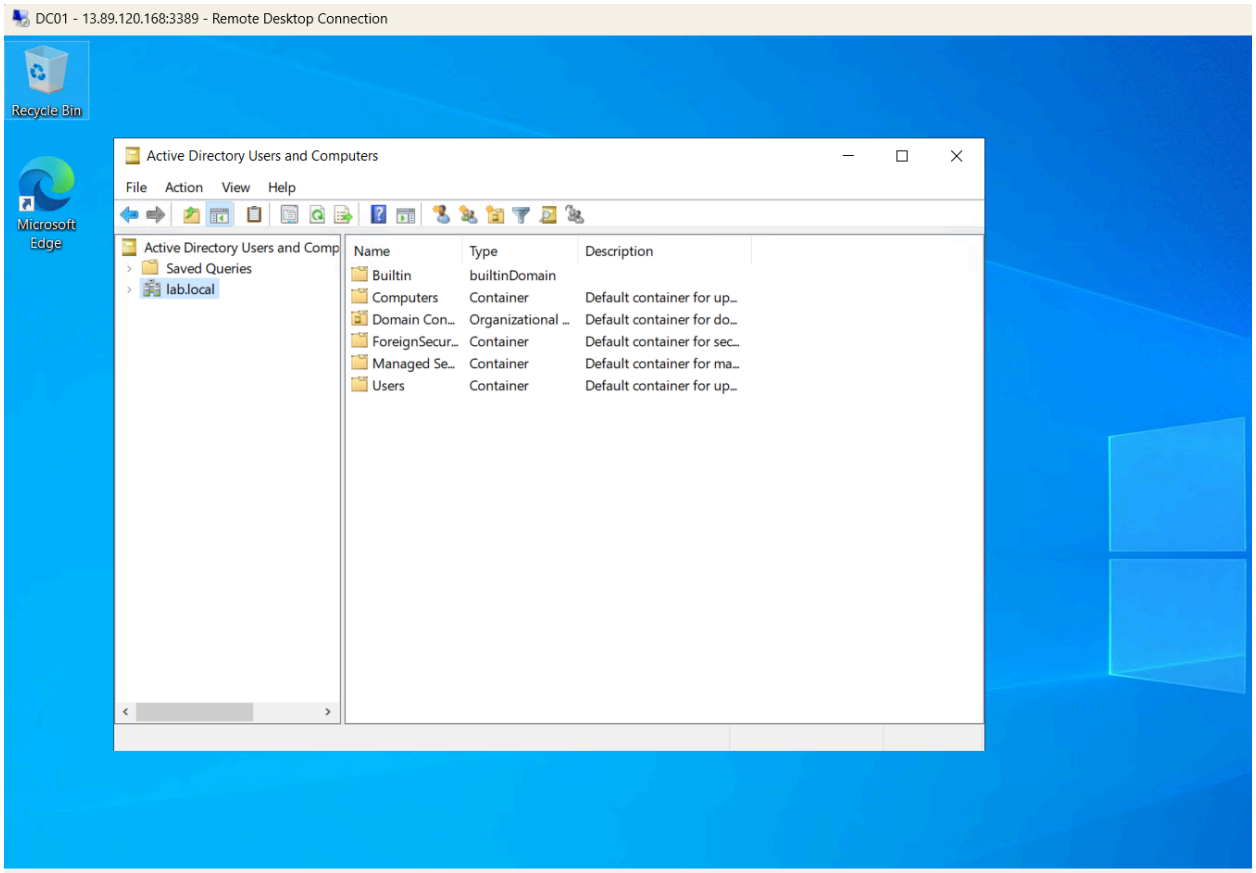
1. Open Active Directory Users and Computers

- Log into the domain controller
- Open the Start Menu
- Search for and open Active Directory Users and Computers



2. Locate the Domain Root

- In the left pane, expand lab.local



- This top-level container is the domain root

I will create a top-level OU to represent organizational structure, rather than placing objects directly at the root.

3. Create the _Branches OU

1. Right-click the domain root
2. Select New → Organizational Unit
3. Name the OU `_Branches`
4. Ensure Protect container from accidental deletion is checked
5. Select OK

4. Create a Branch OU

I will now create an OU for a specific branch. In a real environment, each physical location would have its own OU.

1. Right-click the `_Branches` OU
2. Select New → Organizational Unit
3. Name the OU after a branch

4. Ensure Protect container from accidental deletion is checked
5. Select OK

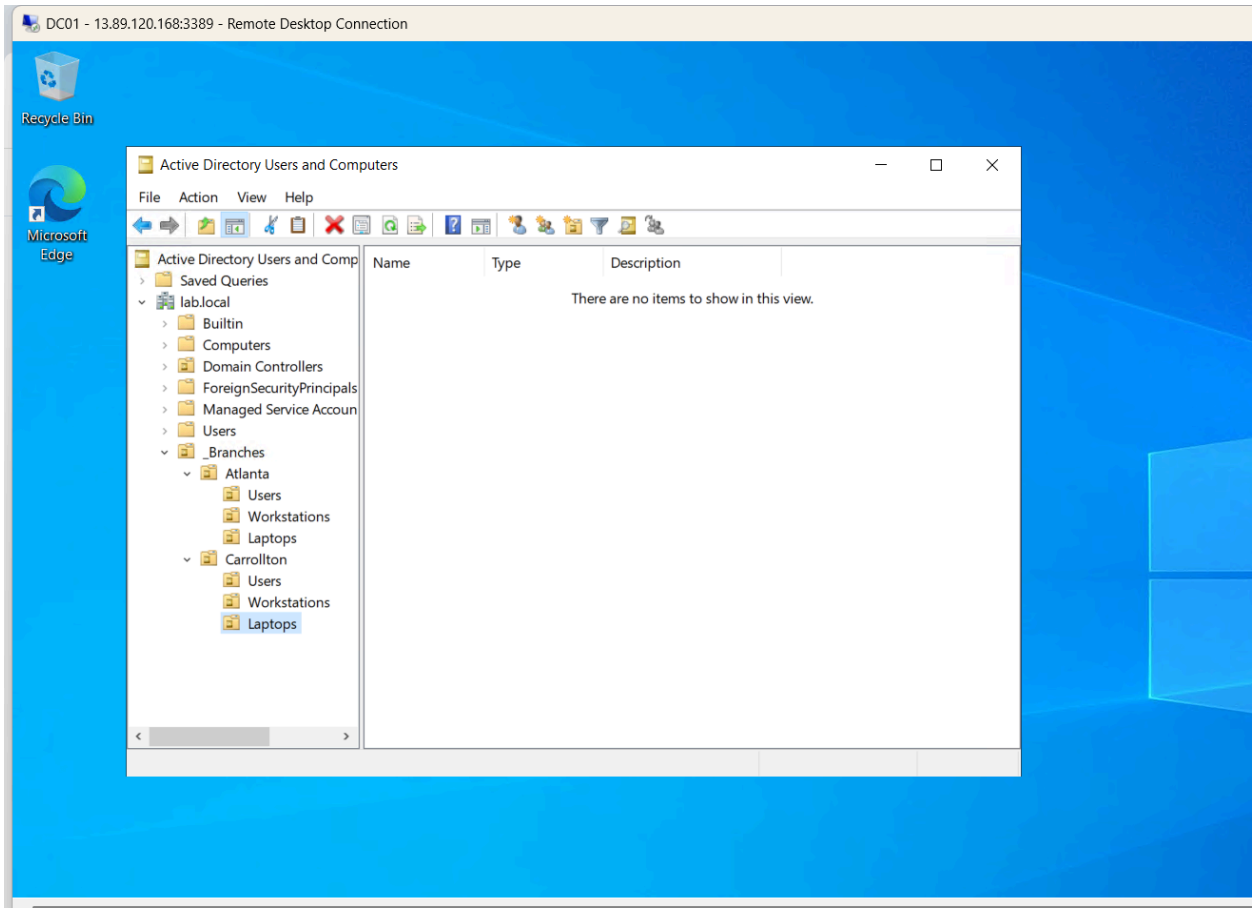
5. Create Sub-OUs for the Branch

Within each branch, separate users and devices to allow targeted policy and easier troubleshooting.

1. Right-click the branch OU
2. Select New → Organizational Unit
3. Name the OU `Users`
4. Repeat to create `Workstations` and `Laptops`
5. Ensure accidental deletion protection is enabled on each OU

6. Verify the OU Structure

- Confirm the OUs exist and are nested correctly



Why Not _Users or _Computers?

In small labs, you may see flat OUs like `_Users` or `_Computers`. In production environments, OUs are almost always organized around policy boundaries such as branch location.

This approach scales better and reflects how Active Directory is managed in real organizations.